

WHERE TO START THE LITERATURE REVIEW

A starting shelf for the Systematic Literature Review. Begin with 01, then follow your own question. A gap (section 04) is a finding: say so in the review.

DRAFT REVIEW DUE NOV. 11, 2026 final with Dec. 16 report	START WITH SECTION 01 five works, one case	THEMES HERITAGE + RETAIL vacancy, trade areas, mix	CASE STUDY 1970S WAVERLY the City's own files
---	---	---	--

01 START HERE

- **Rosen (1974)**. "Hedonic Prices and Implicit Markets." *Journal of Political Economy* 82(1). How to price a building by its attributes.
- **Huff (1964)**. "Defining and Estimating a Trading Area." *Journal of Marketing* 28(3). Where a store draws its customers.
- **Coulson and Leichenko (2001)**. "The Internal and External Impact of Historical Designation on Property Values." *J. of Real Estate Finance and Economics* 23(1). What designation does to a building and its neighbors.
- **Ahlfeldt and Maennig (2010)**. "Substitutability and Complementarity of Urban Amenities: External Effects of Built Heritage in Berlin." *Real Estate Economics* 38(2). Heritage as an amenity, measured.
- **Jacobs (1961)**. *The Death and Life of Great American Cities*. Random House. Why a street needs a mix of uses.
- **The City's own Waverly files (1970s)**. The precedent case. No one has reviewed them. See section 06 of the sponsor handoff.
- **Nominations (PDFs)**. [Waverly Main Street \(B-5229\)](#), [St. John's \(B-3731\)](#), [Peabody Heights \(B-3736\)](#). What the Park Service counted.

02 BALTIMORE: WHAT VACANCY AND REUSE DO

- **Han (2014)**. "The Impact of Abandoned Properties on Nearby Property Values." *Housing Policy Debate* 24(2). The one citable Baltimore study (repeat sales, 1991 to 2010). Each added abandoned property within 250 ft: about -0.9%. Past three years, every ring to 1,500 ft is significant.
- **Miller and McComas (2022)**. *The Costs of Baltimore's Vacant Housing*. JHU 21st Century Cities / Abell Foundation. About \$210M a year to the City. Associational design, and coefficients are log points (-0.30 is about -26%).
- **BNIA-JFI (2016)**. *Evaluation of the Baltimore City Vacants to Value Program*. Assessed value, 2009 to 2014: occupied -1.7%, vacant -12.2%, demolished -34.8%.
- **Abell Report 33(1) (2020)** (Real Property Research Group) and **PlaceEconomics for CHAP (2020)**. Return on the Maryland commercial and Baltimore City historic tax credits.
- **Brown (2021)**. *The Black Butterfly*. Johns Hopkins University Press. The race and space frame for Baltimore property.

03 BEYOND BALTIMORE: HERITAGE, DISTRICTS, SPILLOVERS

- **Patrick (2025)**. "The Value of Historic District Status." *Regional Science and Urban Economics* 115. Atlanta. Listing tied to about 13 to 14%, credit included.
- **Been, Ellen, Gedal, Glaeser and McCabe (2016)**. "Preserving History or Hindering Growth?" *Journal of Urban Economics* 92. See page 2.
- **Ellen, Schwartz and Voicu (2007)**. "The Impact of Business Improvement Districts on Property Values: Evidence from New York City." The one district-scale commercial test: gains inside the boundary, no significant spillover outside.
- **Rossi-Hansberg, Sarte and Owens (2010)**. "Housing Externalities." *Journal of Political Economy* 118(3). Externalities halve about every 1,000 ft.
- **Ganduri and Maturana (2024)**. *Journal of Urban Economics* 143. Spillovers from rehabilitating a neighbor, about +2.3 points per rehab.
- **Immergluck, Kreis and Graziani (2017)**. *The Cost of Vacant and Blighted Properties in Pittsburgh*. Center for Community Progress. Costs commercial vacancy on its own: about \$2,300 a year in lost tax against \$584 residential.
- **Van Leuven**. *Economic Development Quarterly*. The first causal test of the Main Street program, 1997 to 2017, found no effect on jobs or establishments.
- **Methods**. Callaway and Sant'Anna (2021); Sun and Abraham (2021), both *J. of Econometrics* 225(2). Staggered difference-in-differences.

04 READ WITH CARE

GAPS ARE FINDINGS

SAY SO IN THE REVIEW

- No rigorous study isolates what a **vacant commercial** building does to nearby values. Almost every effect size you will find is residential.
- Nobody has measured the **uplift side in Baltimore**. Every local estimate is the penalty of vacancy, not the gain from fixing it.
- Main Street "dollars reinvested" figures are **self-reported tallies**, not impact estimates.
- **Check units**. Per-property effects, yes-or-no effects and log points are not comparable. Do not set them side by side.

HERITAGE AND VALUE, CLOSE UP

The best-studied heritage evidence, much of it from New York and NYU, a review of thirty years of studies, and the newest Waverly reporting. Each entry links to a PDF or its source.

01 NEW YORK'S STUDIES

- **Been, Ellen, Gedal, Glaeser and McCabe (2016).** "Preserving History or Hindering Growth? The Heterogeneous Effects of Historic Districts on Local Housing Markets in New York City." *Journal of Urban Economics* 92. As summarized by the NYU Furman Center: homes in a 250 ft buffer just outside New York's historic districts gain much of the benefit without the restrictions, while in Manhattan districts show no greater gains than comparable surroundings. Working paper (NBER 20446). [PDF](#) [SUMMARY](#)
- **McCabe and Ellen (2016).** "Does Preservation Accelerate Neighborhood Change? Examining the Impact of Historic Preservation in New York City." *Journal of the American Planning Association* 82(2), 134 to 146. Little evidence that designation changes racial composition, but a significant rise in socioeconomic status afterward. Publisher copy: use the NYU library. [DOI](#)

02 THE WIDER LITERATURE

- **Manganelli, Tajani, De Paola and Del Giudice (2023).** "The Impact of the Historical-Architectural Component on Property Value." *Heritage* 6(7). A review of thirty years of studies. Designation can raise or lower values, depending on local versus national designation, architectural style, building type and conservation activity. Open access. [PDF](#) [DOI](#)
- **Narwold (2006).** "Historical Designation and Residential Property Values." 46th Congress of the European Regional Science Association. San Diego under California's Mills Act: designation tied to about a 16% rise in house values, more than the property-tax savings alone explain. One city, one rule: do not generalize. [ECONSTOR](#)

03 THE LAW

- **Steinberg (2011).** "New York City's Landmarks Law and the Rescission Process." *NYU Annual Survey of American Law* 66(4). How landmark decisions are fought over, and how a designation can be undone. [PDF](#)

04 WAVERLY, NOW

- **Gellman and Jayaraman (Oct. 5, 2026).** "Empty storefronts are holding back Waverly. Is one man to blame?" *The Baltimore Banner*. The Banner's own count found more than 1 in 4 buildings on Greenmount between 29th and 35th completely empty. Baltimore does not track long-term empty storefronts, while DC requires a registry within 90 days. Jeff Jetton, a sponsor, is quoted. It carries allegations about named private people, so read it as press, not evidence. [PDF](#) [ORIGINAL](#)

05 READ WITH CARE

BEFORE YOU BORROW A FINDING

ASK WHICH REGIME AND WHICH MARKET

- These studies measure **New York's local landmark districts**, which restrict changes. Waverly's National Register listing is a different regime. Ask which one each study measures.
- Effects differ by market: in Manhattan the costs offset the gains. **Baltimore is not Manhattan**, and San Diego is not either.
- Rising socioeconomic status after designation raises a question for this project: **who stays?**

FROM TENANT TO OWNER

Worker and employee ownership: what the evidence says, how law and policy have used it, and where it stops applying to a tenant who wants the building. Every entry has a link.

01 THE EVIDENCE

- **Foley and Levine (2025).** *Literature Review on Worker Ownership*. UC Berkeley Haas, Institute for Business and Social Impact. A literature review to model yours on: wages, wealth, job stability and productivity across ESOPs and co-ops, focused on low-wage workers. [PAGE](#)
- **Blasi, Freeman and Kruse (2017).** "Evidence: What the U.S. Research Shows about Worker Ownership." *Oxford Handbook of Mutual, Co-Operative and Co-Owned Business*. Firms with profit sharing and employee ownership average higher productivity and pay. Open access. [PDF](#) [DASH](#)
- **The sponsor's case table.** *docs/worker-owned-exits.md* in the repo. Eleven real cases, including Waverly Ace (ESOP), Red Emma's (a worker co-op that bought 3128 Greenmount) and the Wine Source. [REPO](#)

02 LAW, POLICY AND FUNDING

- **Huertas-Noble (2016).** "Worker-Owned and Unionized Worker-Owned Cooperatives: Two Tools to Address Income Inequality." *Clinical Law Review* 22(2). Mondragon and Cooperative Home Care Associates as models; capitalization, co-op ecosystems, municipal support. [PDF](#)
- **Rosen and Wilson (1986-87).** "Employee Ownership: A New Strategy for Economic Development." *N.Y.U. Review of Law and Social Change* 15. ESOP tax benefits as development policy. Written in the 1980s: check which rules still apply. [PDF](#)
- **Theodos, Shakespre and Hariharan (2022).** "Employee Ownership NYC: Cultivating Diverse Funding Streams." Urban Institute. How New York City funds conversions: in FY2020, 12 organizations received \$3.6M for co-op technical assistance, worth up to \$10,000 per business. Fourth of five briefs. [PDF](#)
- **Strine (2019).** "Toward Fair and Sustainable Capitalism." Univ. of Pennsylvania Institute for Law and Economics, Research Paper 19-39. A proposal to restore gainsharing between employees and shareholders by reorienting corporate governance. Written for an NYU conference. [PDF](#)
- **Armeni and Whelan (2018).** "Shareholders Are Stealing Our Jobs." Transform Finance and NYU Stern Center for Sustainable Business. How short-term stock pressure pushes firms to cut labor costs. [PDF](#)

03 WEALTH, RESILIENCE AND OWNERSHIP, NOW

- **Rouen and Hsieh, reported by Perman (Apr. 16, 2026).** "Employee ownership can be a 'powerful' tool to close the wealth gap." Harvard Business School, BiGS. Reports that if all U.S. private companies were 10% employee-owned, Black household wealth would more than double. Press feature: find the study first. [HBS](#)
- **Perman (Nov. 26, 2025).** "Employee-owned companies tend to weather economic downturns." Harvard Business School, BiGS. Reports 1.3% job loss versus 3% elsewhere per point of rising unemployment (1999 to 2011). Press feature: read Kurtulus and Kruse, "How Did Employee Ownership Firms Weather the Last Two Recessions," first. [HBS](#)
- **Villalonga, Tufano and Wang (2025).** "Corporate Ownership and ESG Performance." *Journal of Corporate Finance* 91. Ownership type and ESG outcomes. Read the abstract first to judge fit. [DOI](#)

04 THE OTHER SIDE, AND SMALL FIRMS NOW

- **West and Brady (Oct. 6, 2026).** "Private Equity's Impact on Home Care Workers and Patients in New York State." Cornell ILR Worker Institute. What non-worker ownership can look like: five private equity agencies, low pay and wage theft. A case study, not a sample. [REPORT](#) [NEWS](#)
- **NYU Wagner Financial Access Initiative.** *Small Firm Diaries USA*. A year of financial diaries from 75 to 100 small firms in low-income areas, Baltimore among six cities. No results announced yet. [PAGE](#)

05 READ WITH CARE

WHERE THE EVIDENCE STOPS

SAY HOW FAR IT STRETCHES

- Most of this evidence is about **firms owned by their workers**, or ESOP companies. Very little is about a **tenant buying the building it rents**. For each finding, say how far it stretches to Idea 2.
- Many findings are **averages across firms** that chose ownership and firms that did not. Ask what could explain the gap other than ownership.
- The Harvard pieces are **press features**, the Cornell report covers **five agencies**, and Rosen and Wilson is from the **1980s**. Trace numbers to a study.